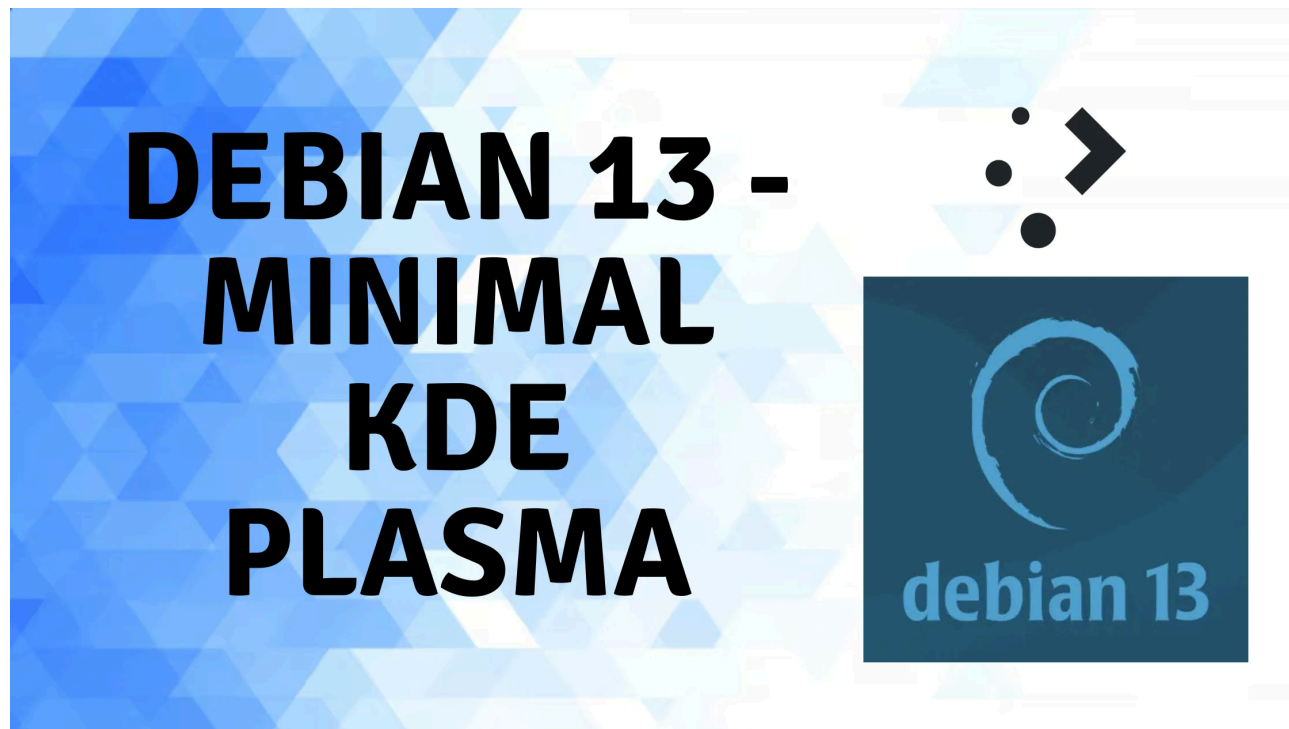


Debian 13 Minimal KDE Plasma Installation & Post-Install Tweaks and Tips

 zihad.com.bd/posts/debian-minimal-kde-plasma-post-install

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Learn how to install Debian 13 with a minimal KDE Plasma setup and optimize your system with essential post-install tweaks. Perfect for users seeking a lightweight and efficient Linux desktop experience.

Debian 13 is one of the most stable and versatile Linux distributions available, and when combined with a minimal KDE Plasma setup, it offers a lightweight yet powerful desktop experience. In this guide, we'll walk you through the Debian 13 minimal installation process and share essential post-install tweaks to optimize your system for performance and usability. Whether you're a beginner or an experienced user, this step-by-step guide will help you set up Debian with KDE Plasma, ensuring a smooth and efficient Linux environment.

Introduction

During Debian install and in **Software selection** uncheck everything except **standard system utilities**

Minimal Plasma Desktop Install

```
sudo apt install kde-plasma-desktop plasma-nm sddm-theme-breeze kwin-  
addons -y
```

Reboot the system. This should give you basic minimal kde plasma setup for debian.

You can also remove some bloats if you have already install kde plasma full

```
sudo apt-get remove --purge 'kontrast*', 'k3b*', 'akregator*', 'imagemagick*', 'kmail*',  
'apper*',  
'dragon*', 'juk*', 'contact*', 'kmousetool*', 'kmouth*', 'kwrite*', 'kmag*', 'konqueror*', 'sieveed  
itor*'
```

Fix Debian ethernet or network not working

Sometimes after installations ethernet network may not work. we can fix it like this.

```
sudo nano  
/etc/network/interfaces
```

comment this:

```
#iface enp4s0f1 inet dhcp                                # comment  
this
```

| or your ethernet device name

You can also edit `/etc/NetworkManager/NetworkManager.conf` to give Network Manager full control over your network devices. Set `managed=true`.

```
[ifupdown  
n]  
managed=  
true
```

Username is not in the sudoers file

To get root, then add your user to the sudo group, use:

```
su -
usermod -aG sudo
YOUR_USERNAME
exit
```

or

```
su
nano
/etc/sudoers
```

Add your user below %sudo EXAMPLE:

```
Defaults      env_reset,pwfeedback
Defaults      mail_badpass
Defaults
secure_path="/usr/local/sbin:/usr/local/bin:/usr/sbin:/usr/bin:/sbin:/bin"
Defaults      insults

# Allow members of group sudo to execute any command
%sudo  ALL=(ALL:ALL) ALL
USER_NAME  ALL=(ALL:ALL) ALL
```

Fastest mirror

Find fastest mirrors. A list of mirrors ranked by speed will be places in your home directory
Copy this list to `/etc/apt/sources.list`

```
sudo apt install
netselect-apt
netselect-apt
sudo apt-get update
```

Install flatpak

Install flatpak and add flathub

```
sudo apt install flatpak
sudo flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub
https://flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
sudo apt install plasma-discover-backend-flatpak
```

Unless you are from developers you should remove the sources files for faster updates.
Go to `/etc/apt/sources.list` and comment out the src lines.

Install some necessary softwares

These are some basic softwares that I like.

```
sudo apt install synaptic breeze-gtk kde-gtk-config kde-config-gtk-style kde-config-gtk-style-preview vlc kdeconnect neovim htop neofetch gstreamer1.0-nice gstreamer1.0-plugins-bad python-is-python3 python3-pip ncdu thunderbird stacer
```

Setup Bootsplash

Bootsplash may not be setup in debian. We can set it manually.

```
sudo apt install plymouth plymouth-themes plymouth-theme-breeze kde-config-plymouth kde-config-sddm sddm-theme-debian-breeze
```

Then add splash in /etc/default/grub

```
# GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT="quiet splash"
```

Update grub

```
sudo update-grub
```

Setup plymouth. Edit /etc/plymouth/plymouthd.conf

```
[Daemon]
Theme=
bgrt
```

Then

```
sudo update-initramfs -u
```

Mount Drives

You may want to mount external drives.

check uuid

```
ls -l /dev/disk/by-  
uuid  
sudo blkid
```

add uuid in /etc/fstab at the bottom

```
# UUID=0d8130f6-ad5a-4df7-9c44-5001f3a950d8 /storage/data ext4 defaults,noatime,x-gvfs-  
show 0 0
```

| Mount in your desired location in replace with /storage/data

32-bit support

Enable 32bit package downloads. (Required for some games)

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture  
i386  
sudo apt update
```

WINE

- wine from wine-hq install [wiki](#)

```
wget -nc https://dl.winehq.org/wine-builds/winehq.key  
sudo apt-key add winehq.key  
sudo echo "deb https://dl.winehq.org/wine-builds/debian/ bullseye main" >  
/tmp/winehq.list  
sudo cp -v /tmp/winehq.list /etc/apt/sources.list.d/  
sudo apt update  
sudo apt install --install-recommends winehq-stable
```

- wine from Debian

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386 && sudo apt update  
sudo apt install wine wine32 wine64 libwine libwine:i386 fonts-wine wine-  
binfmt
```

Mono & Gecko Download and put these here manually /usr/share/wine/

- [Mono](#)
- [Gecko](#)

Example: **MONO**

```
wget https://dl.winehq.org/wine/wine-mono/9.0.0/wine-mono-9.0.0-x86.msi -P  
~/.local/share/wine/mono
```

Gecko (both 32-bit and 64-bit):

```
wget https://dl.winehq.org/wine/wine-gecko/2.47.4/wine-gecko-2.47.4-x86.msi -P  
~/.local/share/wine/gecko  
wget https://dl.winehq.org/wine/wine-gecko/2.47.4/wine-gecko-2.47.4-x86_64.msi -P  
~/.local/share/wine/gecko
```

Install Nvidia Drivers

Install NVIDIA Drivers

```
sudo apt install nvidia-detect  
nvidia-detect  
sudo apt install linux-headers-amd64 nvidia-driver firmware-misc-nonfree mesa-utils mesa-  
utils-extra  
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386 && sudo apt update  
sudo apt install nvidia-driver-libs:i386  
sudo reboot  
nvidia-smi  
watch nvidia-smi
```

Debian Gaming

Install Steam

```
sudo apt install  
steam
```

Hardware Acceleration for Debian

For Intel:

```
sudo apt install intel-media-va-driver-non-free intel-gpu-tools i965-va-driver-shaders  
nvidia-vaapi-driver libnvcuvid1 libnvidia-encode1 vdpauinfo vainfo gstreamer1.0-vaapi  
gstreamer1.0-plugins-bad vulkan-tools
```

Add some environment variable in /etc/environment

```
# Intel  
LIBVA_DRIVER_NAME=i965  
VDPAU_DRIVER=va_gl
```

```
# NVIDIA
#LIBVA_DRIVER_NAME=vdpau
#VDPAU_DRIVER=nvidia
```

check hw acceleration usage

```
vainfo
vdpauinfo
sudo intel_gpu_top
nvidia-smi -q | grep Decoder
watch -n 1 'nvidia-smi -q | grep
Decoder'
```

enable hwacceleration for **mpv** add in `$HOME/.config/mpv/mpv.conf`

hwdec

non-free codecs and other media components

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt install
-y \
  ffmpeg \
  libavcodec-extra \
  ttf-mscorefonts-installer \
  libdvdcss2 \
  libdvd-pkg \
  ffmpegthumbnailer \
  ffmpegthumbs \
  gstreamer1.0-plugins-bad \
  gstreamer1.0-plugins-ugly \
  gstreamer1.0-libav \
  gstreamer1.0-tools \
  gstreamer1.0-vaapi \
  tumbler-plugins-extra \
  kdegraphics-thumbnailers && \
  sudo dpkg-reconfigure libdvd-pkg
```